

Nicolas Wessler

Ph.D. Candidate, UBC Sauder School of Business

nicolas.wessler@sauder.ubc.ca

Research Interests

International Trade, Political Economy, Economic History

Education

University of British Columbia , Sauder School of Business	2021 - present
Ph.D. in Strategy and Business Economics	
Committee: Keith Head, Ayumu Ken Kikkawa, Nathan Nunn	
Advanced Studies Program, Kiel Institute for the World Economy (Germany)	2018 - 2019
Master of Science in Economics, University of Pavia (Italy)	2017 - 2018
Master of Science in Economics, University of Tübingen (Germany)	2016 - 2017
Visiting Student, Kasetsart University (Thailand)	2015 - 2016
Bachelor of Science in Economics, University of Münster (Germany)	2012 - 2016

Research and Work Experience

Pre-Doctoral Research Associate , University of Chicago	2019 - 2021
Prof. Felix Tintelnot & Dr. Alessandra González	
Research Assistant , United Nations ESCAP (Thailand)	2019
Research Assistant , Prof. Andreas Fuchs, Kiel Institute for the World Economy	2018 - 2019
Intern , Economic Policy Forum (Germany)	2016

Awards and Scholarships

UBC Killam Graduate Teaching Award	2025/2026
ReCIPE PhD Research Grant, UK Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office (FCDO)	2025
EDI Research Catalyst Funding, UBC Dhillon Centre	2024
Doctoral Recruitment Fellowship, UBC Sauder School of Business	2021 - 2026
ASP Scholarship, Kiel Institute for the World Economy	2018 - 2019
DAAD Full Year Scholarship	2017

Research

The Cost of Rivalry: Geopolitical Fragmentation and Trade during the Cold War
(with Timothy Meyer, *Job Market Paper*)

Trade Reliance and the Success of Economic Sanctions
Review of World Economics, <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10290-026-00659-y>

The Glass Web: Kinship Networks, Female Executives and Firm Outcomes in the Middle East
(with Alessandra L. González)
Economics of Transition and Institutional Change, <https://doi.org/10.1111/ecot.70037>

Hegemonic Competition with Carrots and Sticks
(with Timothy Meyer)

Presentations

2026: 24th Annual GEP/CEPR Postgrad Conference (Nottingham), Cowles Summer Conference on International Trade (Yale), 8th International Conference on European Economics and Politics (ETH Zurich)
2025: GSIPE Conference (Berkeley), Second Annual Workshop on Sanctions (Vienna), 59th Annual Meetings of the Canadian Economics Association (Montreal), Philly Trade Group at Drexel (Philadelphia)
2024: 58th Annual Meetings of the CEA (Toronto), RIEF Doctoral Meeting (Paris)

Referee Services

Review of World Economics

Other Services

President, UBC Sauder Ph.D. Student Society	2024
Organizer, UBC Trade/Spatial Brownbag Seminar Series	2024

Teaching Experience

University of British Columbia — Instructor	
COMM 394: Environment, Society and Government (Undergraduate)	Summer 2025
Enrollment: 36 students Teaching load: 6 hrs/week Teaching evaluation: 4.9 / 5.0	
University of British Columbia — Teaching Assistant	
COMR 493: Strategic Management in Business (Undergraduate)	Winter 2024, Winter 2023
COMR 491: Strategic Management (Undergraduate)	Winter 2023
COEC 498: Advanced International Business Management (Undergraduate)	Winter 2023
COMM 498: International Business Management (Undergraduate)	Winter 2022
ECON 455: International Trade (Undergraduate)	Winter 2022, Winter 2023

Skills

Languages: English (fluent), German (native), Italian (beginner)
Software: R, Stata, Python, Julia, MATLAB

References

Keith Head

Sauder School of Business, UBC
keith.head@sauder.ubc.ca

Ayumu Ken Kikkawa

Sauder School of Business, UBC
ken.kikkawa@sauder.ubc.ca

Nathan Nunn

Department of Economics, UBC
nathan.nunn@ubc.ca

Updated: July 20, 2026